CRICKET RULES

A structured reference document for ELT (Extract, Load, Transform) pipelines

This document summarizes common cricket rules in clear, reusable sections. It is designed as sample source content for practicing document extraction, text cleaning, transformation, chunking, and loading into a database or search system. Rules can vary by playing format and competition; official playing conditions take precedence.

1. Objective of the Game

Cricket is played between two teams. In a standard international match, each team has 11 players. One team bats to score runs, while the other team bowls and fields to restrict runs and dismiss batters. The team with the higher valid score usually wins, subject to the match format and result rules.

2. The Playing Area and Equipment

• **Pitch:** The central strip where the bowler delivers the ball and the batter faces it.

• **Wickets:** Each end has three stumps with two bails placed on top.

• **Creases:** Marked lines used to judge the batter's safe ground and certain dismissals.

• **Bat and ball:** The batter uses a cricket bat; the bowler delivers a cricket ball.

• **Protective equipment:** Batters commonly wear pads, gloves, and a helmet. Wicketkeepers use gloves and pads.

3. Overs, Deliveries, and Innings

An over normally consists of six legal deliveries bowled by one bowler from one end. A wide or no-ball is not a legal delivery and generally requires an extra delivery in the over. An innings is a team's turn to bat. The number of overs and the number of innings depend on the format.

Format	Typical structure	Important note
Test cricket	Up to two innings per team; played over up to five days.	A draw is possible if time expires without a result.
One Day International (ODI)	Usually up to 50 overs per team.	Limited-overs rules and fielding restrictions apply.
Twenty20 (T20)	Usually up to 20 overs per team.	Short format; match-specific playing conditions apply.

4. Scoring Runs

• **Running between wickets:** Batters score one or more runs by safely completing runs between the wickets.

• **Boundary four:** Four runs are scored when the ball reaches or crosses the boundary after touching the ground within the field.

• **Boundary six:** Six runs are scored when the batter hits the ball over the boundary without the ball touching the ground inside the field first.

• **Extras:** Runs may be awarded for wides, no-balls, byes, and leg-byes. Penalty runs can also apply in specific situations.

5. Common Ways a Batter Can Be Dismissed

Dismissal	Basic explanation
Bowled	The delivered ball hits the stumps and dislodges at least one bail.
Caught	A fielder catches the ball from the bat before it touches the ground.
Leg Before Wicket (LBW)	Under the LBW law, the ball hits the batter's body rather than the bat and the required conditions are met.
Run out	A batter is out of their ground and a wicket is fairly put down while they are attempting a run or returning.
Stumped	The wicketkeeper fairly puts down the wicket while the batter is out of their ground and not attempting a run, subject to the law.
Hit wicket	The batter puts down their own wicket in the circumstances covered by the law.
Obstructing the field	A batter wilfully obstructs or distracts the fielding side in a way covered by the law.

6. Wides, No-Balls, Byes, and Leg-Byes

Wide: A delivery judged too far from the batter to be a fair ball to hit, according to the applicable conditions. A wide normally adds one extra and does not count as one of the six legal balls in the over.

No-ball: An illegal delivery for reasons such as an overstep no-ball or certain dangerous or illegal deliveries. A no-ball normally adds one extra, does not count as a legal ball, and can affect which dismissals are possible.

Bye: Runs scored when the ball passes the batter without touching the bat or body and the batters run, or the ball reaches the boundary.

Leg-bye: Runs scored after the ball contacts the batter's body, provided the relevant legal conditions are met.

7. Roles of Officials

• **Umpires:** Apply the Laws of Cricket, make decisions on the field, and manage fair play.

• **Third umpire:** Where appointed, reviews selected decisions using available video technology.

• **Match referee:** Oversees the match's conduct and compliance with competition regulations.

• **Scorers:** Record runs, wickets, overs, and other match events.

8. How a Match Is Won or Tied

In a limited-overs chase, the chasing team generally wins by reaching the target before its innings ends. The fielding team can win by preventing the target from being reached and dismissing the batting side or exhausting its overs, subject to the format's rules. A match can be tied when scores are equal under the applicable result rules. In multi-day cricket, a draw is possible. Some competitions use a Super Over or another tie-break procedure.

9. Fair Play and Match Conditions

Players are expected to respect umpires, opponents, and the spirit of the game. Rules cover illegal bowling actions, ball tampering, player conduct, dangerous play, and unfair advantage. Rain, bad light, or unsafe ground conditions can interrupt play. Competition-specific playing conditions determine revised targets, minimum overs, and whether a result is possible.

10. Suggested ELT Pipeline Fields

For practice, an ELT pipeline can extract the sections from this PDF, load the raw text into a staging table, and transform it into structured records. Example fields are shown below.

Field	Example value	Purpose
document_id	cricket_rules_001	Unique document identifier
section_title	Scoring Runs	Topic or section name
rule_name	Boundary four	Normalized rule label
rule_text	Four runs are scored when...	Extracted rule content
source_file	cricket_rules_for_elt_pipeline.pdf	Data lineage and traceability

Note: This is an educational summary, not a replacement for the official Laws of Cricket or a tournament's playing conditions. For production use, validate rule details against the governing body's current rules.